

PAOLA HEUDEBERT

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With a proven track record in managing deep-tech projects and an interdisciplinary background, I am uniquely positioned for operative roles at the intersection of AI innovation and collective transformation. As a former lawyer, I navigate ambiguity with ease and translate complexity into clarity - designing strategies that serve both human and more-than-human futures.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCES

Futurekind AI fellowship | FELLOW (Remote) 2025 – Present

- Researching the frontier of AI and animal welfare through a first-of-its-kind interdisciplinary program, combining hands-on project work with mentorship from leading experts in AI, ethics, and animal communication.

European Commission | INDEPENDENT EXPERT (Brussels, BL) 2023 – Present

- Steer strategic oversight and auditing high-impact projects in AI, blockchain, and digital commons, supporting the Next Generation Internet initiative for responsible and innovative digital transformation across Europe.

Archipels | HEAD OF LEGAL AND PUBLIC AFFAIRS (Paris, FR) 2021 – 2023

- Led the legal team and managed institutional affairs for French blockchain joint-venture founded by major CAC 40 companies.
- Successfully coordinated a €9M funding round involving a complex antitrust case with the European Commission.
- Participated in C-level strategic decision-making, driving company-wide adaptations to regulatory changes that shaped corporate strategy and led to the company's selection in the EU Digital Wallet Consortium and Secure Identity Alliance.
- Defined the legal roadmap and developed one of the first fully GDPR-compliant blockchain strategies, covering NIS requirements.
- Structured and implemented the governance model of the blockchain infrastructure from the ground up.

Int. Assoc. for Trusted Blockchain Applications | CO-CHAIR PRIVACY WORKING GROUP (Brussels, BL) 2021 – 2023

- Played a key role in lobbying with the European Commission, telecom attachés, and MPs to secure the recognition of blockchains and DLTs in the European Digital Identity Framework, successfully maintaining electronic ledger provisions in the final regulations.
- Managing editor of INATBA's most downloaded report: "Data Privacy Regulations Applicable to Blockchain Technology Worldwide," establishing it as a key reference on data privacy regulations for blockchain.
- Represented the Association at international conferences and events, enhancing its influence and visibility.

French Federation of Blockchain Professionals | REGULATION COMMITTEE MEMBER (Paris, FR) 2021 – 2023

- Drafted amendments to the French Postal and Electronic Communications Code, establishing the evidential value of blockchain and DLTs, and co-authored a position paper advocating for this legal innovation.
- Direct lobbying to French Ministry of Economy and Finance.

Entrepreneur First | FOUNDER IN RESIDENCE (Paris, FR) 2020 – 2021

- Selected from a pool of 10,000 applicants for global talent investment program focused on building high-impact tech startups.
- Collaborated with other top-tier entrepreneurs, explored technological projects, and honed skills in early-stage biz development.
- Developed product-market fit strategies and investor pitching through intensive mentorship.

Blockchain for Human Rights | CO-FOUNDER (London, UK) 2018 – 2020

- Co-founded initiative to educate and advocate for blockchain's application in addressing human rights issues.
- Presented the world's first conference on "Tackling Human Rights Problems with Blockchain Technology" at Yale Law School's

EDUCATION & QUALIFICATIONS

New York State Board of Law Examiners | Attorney at law (NY, USA) 2019 - Present

Paris I Sorbonne University | Accelerated BA in Art History, *Honors* (Paris, FR) 2024

Paris-X Nanterre University | Diploma in Ethics, Social Studies and Philosophy, *High Honors* (Paris, FR) 2020

UC Berkeley Law School | LL.M. specialization Law & Technology (CA, USA) 2018
Scholarships: Fulbright Scholar; Monahan Foundation Scholar; Leonora Lindsey Fellow

UC Berkeley Haas School of Business | Credited Courses in Entrepreneurship and Strategic Leadership (CA, USA) 2018

Paris-II Panthéon-Assas University | Dual Masters (Paris, FR) 2015-2016

- Intellectual Property Law, *High Honors, Valedictorian*. Thesis: "Laws of Trademark and Domain Pertaining to Public Bodies"
- Business Law

Paris-IV Sorbonne University & Paris-II Panthéon-Assas University | Dual BA in History and Law, *Honors* (Paris, FR) 2013

SKILLS

- French: native | English: fluent
- Deep-tech operations
- Artificial intelligence
- Interdisciplinary thinking
- Research and foresight
- Early-stage project management
- Blockchain and DLTs
- Problem-solving mindset